



**ANZ, CBA, NAB and Westpac – shares in  
joint venture and interests in Joint Cash Pool**

MN-20014

# **Phase 1 Determination**

**Acquisition may be put into effect**

26 June 2026

# 1. Determination and statement of reasons

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| <p><b>Notified acquisitions</b></p>       | <p>Australia and New Zealand Banking Group Limited (<b>ANZ</b>), Commonwealth Bank of Australia (<b>CBA</b>), National Australia Bank Limited and National Australia Investment Capital Pty Ltd (<b>NAB</b>), and Westpac Banking Corporation (<b>Westpac</b>) (together, the <b>Major Banks</b>) propose to enter into a joint venture for the establishment of a new joint single cash pool (<b>Joint Cash Pool</b>) between the Major Banks with respect to wholesale and ‘commercial cash’ distribution (the <b>Proposed JV</b>).</p> <p>As part of the Proposed JV, each Major Bank will acquire:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• a 25% shareholding in an incorporated operating entity (<b>JVCo</b>), and</li> <li>• a 25% interest in the Joint Cash Pool</li> </ul> <p>(together, the <b>Acquisitions</b>).</p> <p>The Acquisitions represent a narrow part of the arrangements in relation to the establishment of JVCo and the Joint Cash Pool. The remaining conduct relating to the establishment and operation of JVCo and the Joint Cash Pool is the subject of a separate application for authorisation (<a href="#">AA1000729</a>) under section 88 of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the <b>Act</b>) (the <b>Authorisation Application</b>).</p>                                                                                                                                          |
| <p><b>Determination</b></p>               | <p>The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the Act that the Acquisitions may be put into effect.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p><b>Parties to the Acquisitions</b></p> | <p>Each Major Bank is a party to the Proposed JV. Currently, the Major Banks purchase banknotes from the RBA and coins from the Mint directly and each Major Bank has its own cash reserves, which are managed as four separate ‘virtual’ cash pools. Each Major Bank uses their own cash pool to support the supply of cash to their own branches and ATMs, and directly to business customers in some instances.</p> <p>Westpac is currently the sole supplier of commercial cash to distributors other than the Major Banks, including cash-in-transit providers (<b>Commercial Cash Distributors</b>). Customers of Commercial Cash Distributors include smaller banks, major retailers and small businesses. Westpac has decided to cease its current arrangements as the sole supplier of commercial cash.</p> <p>Once the Proposed JV is established, and subject to the outcome of the separate Authorisation Application, the Proposed JV would:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• hold the cash in the Joint Cash Pool as bailee for the Major Banks as joint bailors</li> <li>• supply cash from the Joint Cash Pool to each of the Major Banks (in their capacity as customers of JVCo), in order to meet their cash requirements, including for their own branches and ATMs, and</li> <li>• become the sole supplier of commercial cash to in-scope Commercial Cash Distributors from the Joint Cash Pool.</li> </ul> |

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| <b>Overlap and relationship between the parties</b> | Relevantly, the Major Banks currently overlap in the acquisition, supply and distribution of banknotes and coins in Australia.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Reasons for determination</b>                    | <p>When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (<b>ACCC</b>) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the Act. In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers.</p> <p>For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's <a href="#">merger assessment guidelines</a> and <a href="#">interim merger process guidelines</a>.</p> <p>In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form and the Authorisation Application, as well as information provided by third parties regarding the Acquisitions and interim request for authorisation.</p> <p>The ACCC has determined that the Acquisitions may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisitions are unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material currently before it, the ACCC makes the following findings.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The establishment and operation of the Proposed JV is subject to the ACCC's final determination on the Authorisation Application, which is still under consideration.</li> <li>• The Acquisitions are a necessary step in the establishment of the Proposed JV but would not, without authorisation being granted, result in any changes to the status quo in the acquisition, supply and distribution of banknotes and coins in Australia. In particular, the Major Banks will not cease operating their individual cash pools, and the Proposed JV will not replace Westpac as the sole supplier of commercial cash, unless the ACCC separately grants authorisation for conduct relating to the establishment and operation of JVCo and the Joint Cash Pool.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Applications for review</b>                      | A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act**